

Google Reveals How Much Energy A Single AI Prompt Uses

Posted by u/energysage-official • 0 points • 6 comments

Google just pulled back the curtain on one of tech's best-kept secrets: exactly how much energy its Gemini AI uses with every prompt. The answer—0.24 watt-hours (Wh) per median query—might seem small at first (about the same as running your microwave for one second). But multiply that by billions of daily interactions, and it suddenly becomes clear just how much energy AI is really using every day.

This level of transparency in a new report from Google provides comprehensive data on per-prompt energy usage. It's a wake-up call about how Silicon Valley's AI race will impact the trajectory of clean energy demand—and translate into increased energy costs for everyday Americans.

Comments

u/FriendComplex8767 • 1 points • 2025-09-07 01:46 UTC

Is the energy use productive though?

If that one second spike of energy generated 1 hours worth of work for a programmer or writer that seems damn good value.

u/ReaditTrashPanda • 1 points • 2025-09-03 20:28 UTC

How much is a standard search?

u/Brugelbach • 1 points • 2025-09-04 13:26 UTC

About three fiddy

u/AdAnnual5736 • 3 points • 2025-09-03 18:43 UTC

So, about as much as scrolling Twitter for 15 minutes on an iPhone or running a led lightbulb for 2 minutes. Why aren't people freaking out about the energy draw of Twitter scrolling or room lighting? Why aren't people shaming others for having brighter rooms than they need the way they shame people for using AI?

u/First_Seat_6043 • 4 points • 2025-09-03 17:29 UTC

Simple fix: every time I get in the mood for a good rabbit hole adventure, I turn off the AC beforehand. When you think about it this way, I'm actually saving energy, and the world - thank you David! You're

welcome world.

u/Aggravating-Age-1858 • 1 points • 2025-09-03 17:13 UTC

every time you use an ai prompt a panda goes bye bye

;-)

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-09-03 17:10 UTC

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If your post is a DALL-E 3 image post, please reply with the prompt used to make this image.

Consider joining our [public discord server](<https://discord.gg/r-chatgpt-1050422060352024636>)! We have free bots with GPT-4 (with vision), image generators, and more!

🤖

Note: For any ChatGPT-related concerns, email support@openai.com

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